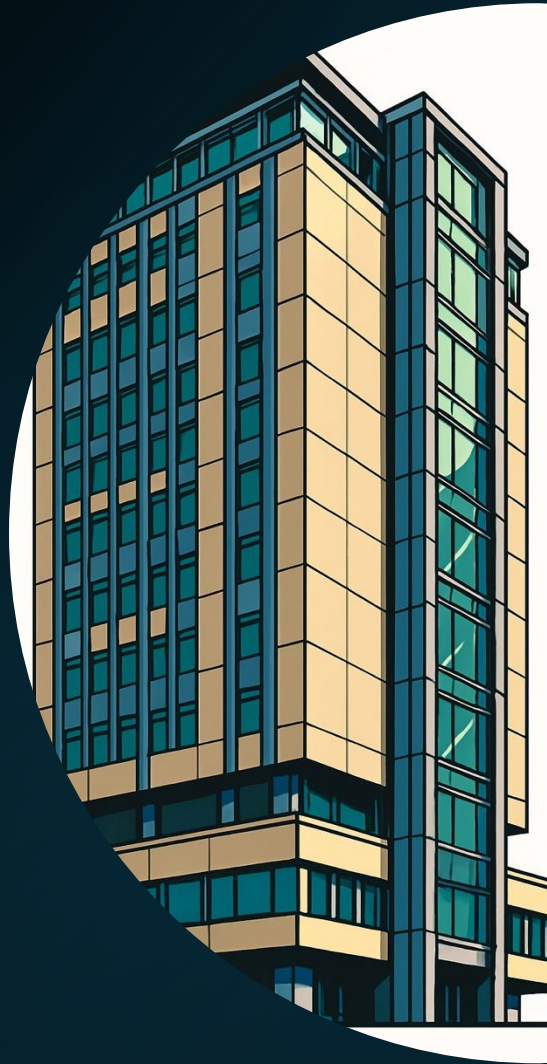


TeachAthon 2026: Opening

Teaching Hours, October 5th 2026



COMPUTER
SCIENCE
EDUCATION
GROUP



SYNTHETIC PROCESSES
& EMBODIMENT LABS

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Synthetic Processes & Embodiment Labs (SPEL)

Principal's Teaching Award Scheme in:

GenAI Integration in Computer Science Education at the University of Edinburgh

Aurora Constantin, Cristina Adriana Alexandru, Fiona Mcneill, Heather Yorston, Judy Robertson, Pavlos Andreadis (PI), Stuart King, Vidminas Vizgirda; and Anya Habana, Aagoon Chakraborty, Kashvi Chabbra.

Funding & Acknowledgements



- **Prize funding (£1,500 total) – SPEL (2/3), CSEG (1/3)**
- **Pizza by SPEL**
- **Further development with SPEL**
 - Selected projects may receive further funding and opportunities to collaborate with SPEL.

SPEL thanks [Ruth Fornell](#), CEO of Poppulo, for her generous donation that makes this event possible.



What...



- **Hackathon for GenAI in Education**
 - Shortlisted submissions shared online – check last years' winners!
<https://github.com/Synthetic-Processes-Embodiment-Labs/TeachAthon-2025>
- **£1500 in prizes** [[Love2Shop vouchers](#)]
 - 1st: £500
 - 2nd & 3rd: £300
 - 4th & 5th: £200
- You will need to >
 - Identify a gap / problem / opportunity in studies
 - Submit a 3-page report
 - Optional (but strongly encouraged):
 - a functional demo or online presentation (e.g. code, prototype, Figma, video)



These slides...



[https://github.com](https://github.com/Synthetic-Processes-Embodiment-Labs/TeachAthon-2026)
[/Synthetic-Processes-Embodiment-Labs](https://github.com/Synthetic-Processes-Embodiment-Labs/TeachAthon-2026)
[/TeachAthon-2026](https://github.com/Synthetic-Processes-Embodiment-Labs/TeachAthon-2026)



... Why



Optimism Gap: GenAI as a 24/7 tutor - Concerns about ethics, assessment integrity and skills erosion.

Policies don't translate clearly to practice.

Guidance needed: need to model & structure responsible use.

Learning at Risk: "hallucinated understanding"

Assessments Arms Race

Staff Capacity

A shifting world...



Criteria



Potential Scope & Impact

- Does the idea address a real problem or opportunity?
- Could it significantly improve the student or teaching experience?

Feasibility

- Is the solution practical within current or near-term GenAI capabilities?
- Is the process clearly explained?

Ethics & Appropriate Use

- Does it consider responsible deployment?
- Are risks (bias, misuse, fairness) acknowledged and addressed?

Demonstration & Project Completion

- Does the submission include a demo, prototype, or example?
- Is there a clear path to implementation or completion? (having code is good, but a realistic path matters most)



Timeline & Support



Team Registration

Deadline: Monday October 19th, 23:59

Please register your team here: [TeachAthon 2026 - Team Registration – Fill in form](#) (you can edit to change/add members)

Teams from 1 to 10 (Higher Education; need to register with institutional student email)

Help with forming teams: [MS Teams | TeachAthon 2026 - Team Assembly](#)

Submission Deadline:

Monday October 26th, 23:59 (Form circulated after Team Registration deadline)

[Drafts accepted; chance to improve up till presentation and can edit afterwards before release]

Submission template: <https://edin.ac/42Oax7x>

Notification of shortlisting:

Thursday October 29th, 12:00 (noon)

Office Hours [Pavlos Andreadis]:

Mon & Tue 13:00 – 14:00

AT Floor 8 / MS Teams

Presentations for Shortlisted submissions, Closing event:

Monday November 2nd, 12:00 – 15:00, Informatics Forum G.03 & Online

Feel free to message me on Teams

